> and die when that is gone. -- Men in Cutch graze and browse, like cattle.

India recovered, though famine had come many times before and it would come again. In the years following the tragedy, Britain took on a variety of important projects in order to strengthen and sustain the newest part of its empire. Railroads were constructed, trade operations were managed better than before, and a world-changing agricultural operation was employed in Darjeeling. Tea was about to revolutionize Indian farming and exports.

Tea had been one of the most popular imports from Asia for centuries by that point, but it came largely from China, and the powerful Qing Dynasty forbade the export of its tea seeds and plants. Scottish botanist, Robert Fortune, was tasked with infiltrating the Chinese tea industry, learning how to process the goods and getting some of the raw materials back home. Fortune dressed as a wealthy Mandarin and took a local companion with him to act as his servant. The servant told the factory administrators that his master had traveled a great distance to see how such wonderful tea was made, and he was politely admitted within.

Fortune managed to learn everything he needed to know and smuggle the important specimens out of China in specially constructed glass cases. In all, he shipped an estimated 20,000 tea plants to England this way. He also smuggled several varieties of roses and other plants that captured his interest. The tea and the flowers proved best suited for India, rather than the British Isles. They were transplanted into fields in Darjeeling and tended by Chinese workers who had also been illegally exported from China. Though the plants had a rough start and many didn’t survive, India soon overtook China as the world’s largest tea producer.

With agriculture, industry, and infrastructure evolving, Britain concentrated on educating and “civilizing” the Indians under their command. It was made mandatory for schools to teach in English, though most schools were comprised only of male students. To know English was to be better prepared for administrative and well-paid jobs under the Raj, and therefore the gender gap in education kept most females from earning decent wages, if not totally from any sort of gainful employment. In addition to mandating the use of English and Anglican church service attendance, the British Crown encouraged its Indian subjects to mimic English culture in terms of sports and fashion.